very different things from our careers. He was seemingly driven by everything that came by being good, whereas I felt like my only motivation was trying to be as effective as I could to help the team to win. When there was enough harmony and a feeling of balance, these things merged together to feel like the same thing. It was only when things started to shake – in the face of a South African team with a motive and enough passion and skill to do real damage – that it became clear just how far apart each philosophy was.

It was a shame the cricket became second best because, beneath the noise and underneath it all, as we lost a series for the first time in years, I watched with admiration the South African pace attack, who had worked out how to bowl in England. Our batters hated facing Vernon Philander because he didn't bowl a bad ball and was always on the money. We bowlers much preferred blocking Vern than having to face Morne Morkel and Dale Steyn, who were both incredibly quick, offering different angles and problems. It was Steyn in particular who, for the first time in a long time, was a bowler I looked at and thought, *I'd love to be able to bowl like that*.